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Arista Networks (ANET.N)

Citi Global TMT Conference Takeaways - Positive

CITI'S TAKE

We hosted Arista CFO Chantelle Breithaupt and SVP, Cloud and AI Networking Tyson Lamoreaux at Citi's Global TMT conference. Please see key takeaways below.

Growth outlook – To get an accurate picture of company growth, Arista encouraged investors to look at reported revenue, deferred revenue trends (4 to 6 quarter trend) , purchase commitments, and remaining performance obligations. Management believes we are 2.5 to 3 years into the current AI cycle which likely has several years of runway ahead, compared to the prior cloud cycle that lasted for approximately three years.

AI Networking Positioning and Etherlink portfolio – Arista's heritage in high-performance cloud networking positions the company well for AI workloads, which require significantly greater reliability, scalability, power efficiency, and performance than traditional data center applications, according to management. The company highlighted its Etherlink portfolio as benefiting from Arista's expertise in hardware engineering, signal integrity, cooling, software reliability, and operational uptime. Arista emphasized that AI infrastructure places a premium on maximizing accelerator utilization, making networking reliability increasingly critical.

Supply chain and demand visibility: Management stated that its supply conditions have improved materially since earlier in the year but that the industry remains constrained. Arista has secured key supply arrangements across semiconductors and memory and believes it is well positioned through 2027. The company's purchase commitments have essentially tripled over the past three quarters to \$9.6B, which is a reflection of customer demand and long-term planning rather than just supply concerns.

Scale-Across evolving: Scale-across networking is currently about one-third of Arista's AI sales but has room to expand. While constraints (space and power) have been the key driver, management sees government initiatives as another contributor. The company gave South Korea as an example where government policy requires distributed generation and local consumption of power resulting in distribution of data centers geographically.

Scale-Up still ahead: Management reiterated that Arista has no scale-up revenue in its guidance for 2026, but expects pilots and early trials to begin in 2027 as the

Buy

Price (10 Sep 26 16:00)	US\$188.99
Target price	US\$215.00
Expected share price return	13.8%
Expected dividend yield	2.4%
Expected total return	16.1%
Market Cap	US\$238,359M

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

Ethernet scale-up ecosystem matures. Commercial revenue is expected beginning in 2028. Arista views scale-up as a significant market opportunity that will evolve across proprietary systems (NVLink and UALink), lower-cost white-box solutions, and value-added Ethernet solutions where Arista intends to compete. The company sees scale-up networking requirements around reliability, telemetry, automation, and security of EOS to be critical differentiators particularly as the market moves beyond hyperscalers.

Optics Roadmap and XPO Strategy: Arista reiterated that they are customer driven and are ready to build NPO or CPO solutions if customers ask them to. However, the company views XPO as an intermediate solution that extends bandwidth density and reach beyond what copper can support while the broader industry ecosystem develops around CPO. Arista expects XPO deployments to begin in 2H27, with broader adoption in 2028, while CPO adoption is expected roughly a year later.

Margins and Operating Leverage: Arista highlighted the significant operating leverage in the model, given operating expenses do not have to scale at the same rate as revenues. The company will continue to invest in R&D (8-10% of sales), sales and go-to-market (5-7%) and G&A (~1%), but management noted there is room for expansion over time.

Arista Networks

Valuation

We value ANET at \$215, or at a 36x P/E multiple, of our 2028 EPS power. Our target multiple is based on the stock's three-year average and reflects lower market multiples.

Risks

Downside risks to our target price include: 1) weaker sales due to lower spend by, or the loss of, one of Arista's two top cloud customers; 2) share losses from competition data center switch vendors; 3) lower gross margins due to protracted supply chain disruptions and elevated logistics costs; and 4) a slower economic environment.

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Appendix A-1

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Arista Networks (ANET)

Ratings and Target Price History

Fundamental Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 14-Dec-23 05:00:00	1	*75.00	57.76
2 07-Mar-24 22:14:38	1	*82.50	71.62
3 27-Jun-24 05:00:00	1	*96.25	86.98
4 07-Oct-24 09:53:48	1	*115.00	98.14
5 19-Feb-25 00:23:59	1	*121.00	103.92

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
6 14-Apr-25 05:00:00	1	*92.00	73.59
7 06-May-25 23:11:28	1	*97.00	90.77
8 13-May-25 14:43:56	1	*112.00	97.25
9 11-Jul-25 00:00:00	1	*123.00	108.57
10 05-Aug-25 23:35:58	1	*136.00	118.12

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
11 12-Sep-25 07:15:51	1	*176.00	139.39
12 05-May-26 23:13:01	1	*173.00	170.22
13 05-Aug-26 06:12:05	1	*215.00	197.31

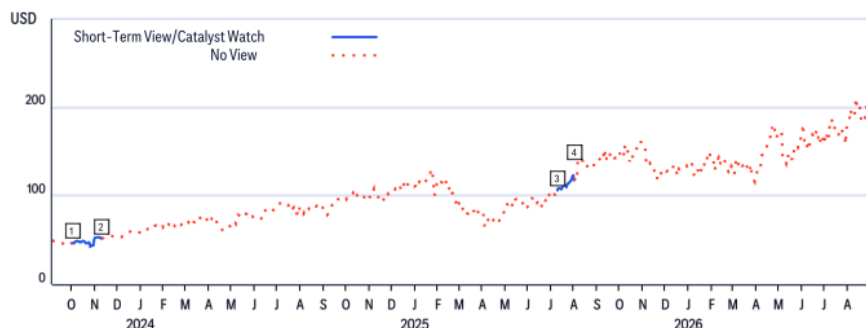
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Arista Networks (ANET)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1 02-Oct-23 21:00:00	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	46.95
2 10-Nov-23 03:10:53	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	51.71

Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
3 10-Jul-25 20:00:00	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	106.29
4 01-Aug-25 01:00:00	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	117.57

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

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% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	38%	42%	27%	42%	37%	36%

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